

Story Problems: World Cup Edition

Key Words to Know

Add to / Agregar: putting more together (joining)

Take away / Quitar: removing some (separating)

Story problem / Problema: math written as a story

Problem 1: World Cup Teams

Story: A soccer team has 7 players on the field. Then 2 more players come onto the field. How many players are on the field now?

You can show this problem in different ways:

Ways to Represent

Act it out: Use your body or counters to show: 7 players, then add 2 more

Draw: Draw 7 circles for players. Then draw 2 more circles. Count all of them.

Use objects: Put 7 counters in a group. Add 2 more. Count together.

Now you try: Show the problem in one way that makes sense to you.

Problem 2: Scoring Goals

Story: A team scored 10 goals in the season. Then they took 3 goals away (they don't count anymore).
How many goals do they have now?

Remember: "Take away" means we remove or separate some.

Sentence Starters (Use These!)

First, I had ___ goals

Then, I took away ___

Now, I have ___ goals

Now you try: Show the problem in one way that makes sense to you.

Problem 3: Fans in the Stadium

Story: There were 8 fans cheering for the red team. There were 5 fans cheering for the blue team. How many fans are cheering altogether?

You can show this problem by:

- Making two groups (red fans and blue fans) with objects
- Drawing two groups and counting them all together
- Acting out being fans from each team

Now you try: Show the problem in one way that makes sense to you.

Challenge Problem (For Fast Finishers)

Story: A player had 6 soccer balls. She gave away 2 soccer balls to a friend. How many soccer balls does she have left?

Show it two different ways:

Way 1:

Way 2:

Extra Challenge

Make your own World Cup story problem! Write it down or tell it to your teacher. Ask a friend to solve it using objects or drawings.